

XnView MP - Quick Reference

Fast photo browsing, marking & selection workflow

Setup (one time)

- **Thumbnail size:** View > Thumbnail Size - set to the largest that fits (256px or 512px)
- **Quality:** Tools > Settings > Thumbnail > Quality - set to High for better previews
- **Filter bar:** View > Show Filter Bar - enables quick filename filtering

Browsing photos

- Left panel: Navigate to your Google Drive folder
- **Recursive view:** View > Explore Recursively (folder icon with arrow) - shows ALL photos from subfolders in one flat view. This is the key feature for browsing thousands of photos across subfolders.
- **Fullscreen:** Spacebar or Enter on a thumbnail opens fullscreen preview. Arrow keys to flip through. Esc to go back to grid.

Marking / selecting photos

Method 1: Star rating (fastest)

- Hover a thumbnail, press 1-5 to rate it (e.g. press 1 to tag as selected)
- Then filter by rating: View > Filter > 1 star to see only your picks

Method 2: Color labels

- Right-click > Set Label > pick a color
- Filter by label to see your selections

Method 3: Tag / flag

- Press T to tag/flag a photo (toggles a checkmark)
- Edit > Select All Tagged to select all flagged photos

Copying your selections

Once you've rated/tagged your ~20 photos:

- Filter to show only tagged/rated photos
- Ctrl+A to select all
- Right-click > Copy to folder... or drag them to your destination

Keyboard shortcuts

- 1-5** - Set star rating on selected thumbnail
- T** - Toggle tag/flag on photo
- Space / Enter** - Open fullscreen preview
- Esc** - Back to thumbnail grid
- P** - Toggle preview pane (split view)

Ctrl+Shift+R - Toggle recursive subfolder view

F11 - Fullscreen slideshow mode

Ctrl+A - Select all visible photos

Pro tips

- The star rating method is the fastest: browse large thumbnails with recursive view, tap 1 on keepers, then filter and copy.
- Thumbnail caching means second visits to the same folder are instant.
- Use the preview pane (P) for a split view: large preview on top, thumbnails below.